

25 Career Advices You Wish You Knew Earlier

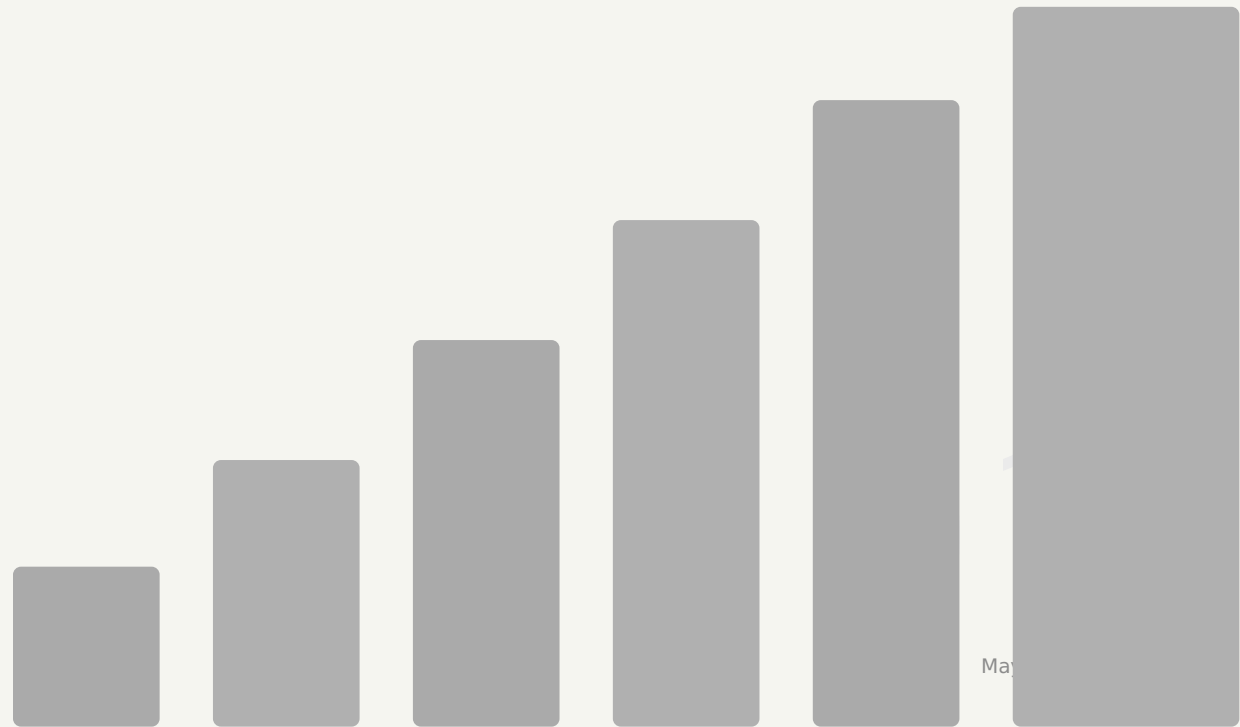
Hard-won lessons on work, growth, money, and people.





Early Career

What nobody tells you when you're just starting out.



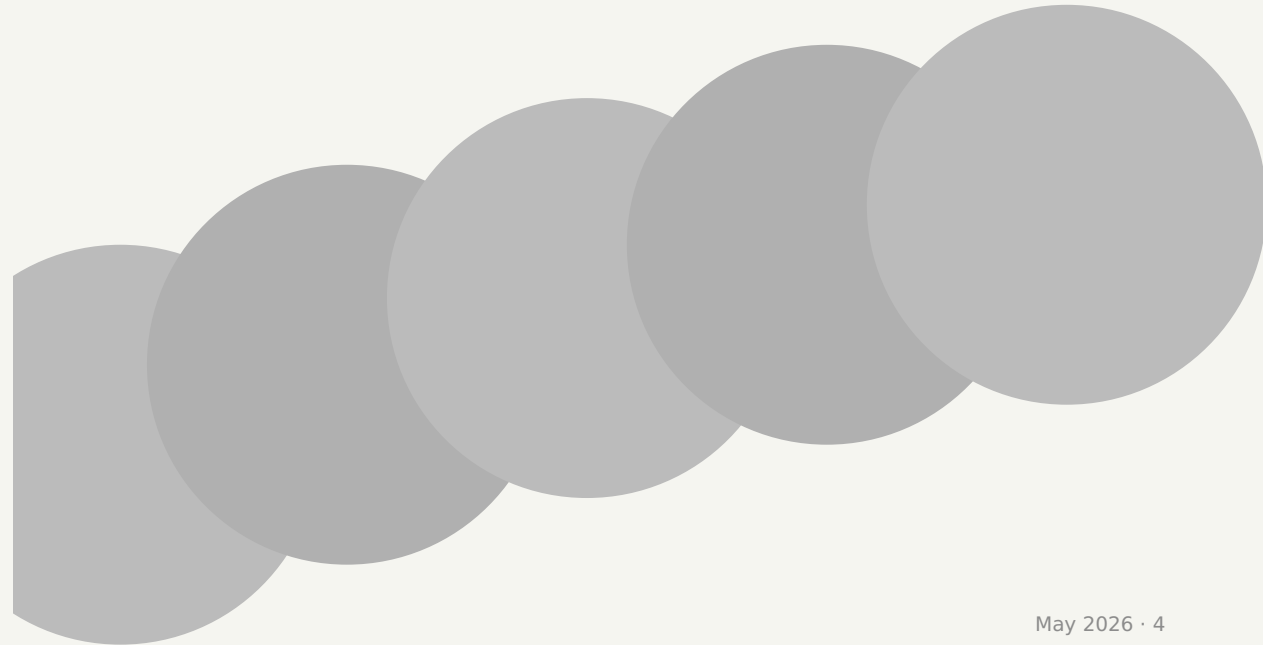
Early on, you get paid
for what you **can do**.

Later you get paid for what you *actually do*.
Your potential is currency — spend it wisely.



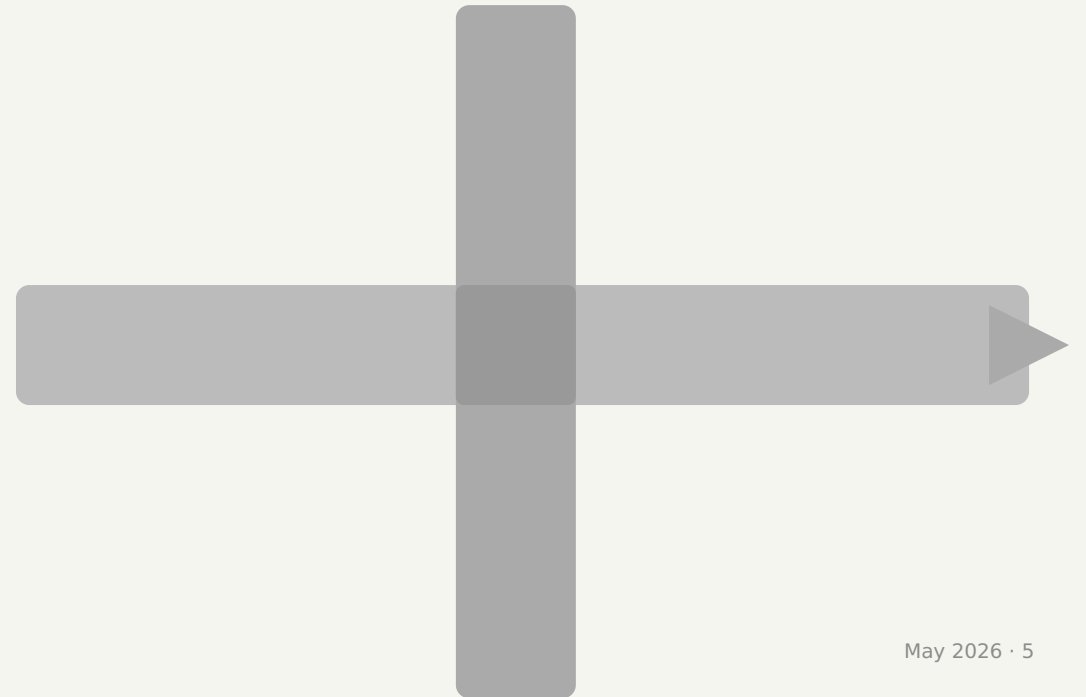
5 years of experience
 $\neq$ 1 year done 5 times.

Make every year count differently.
Compound learning — not repetition.



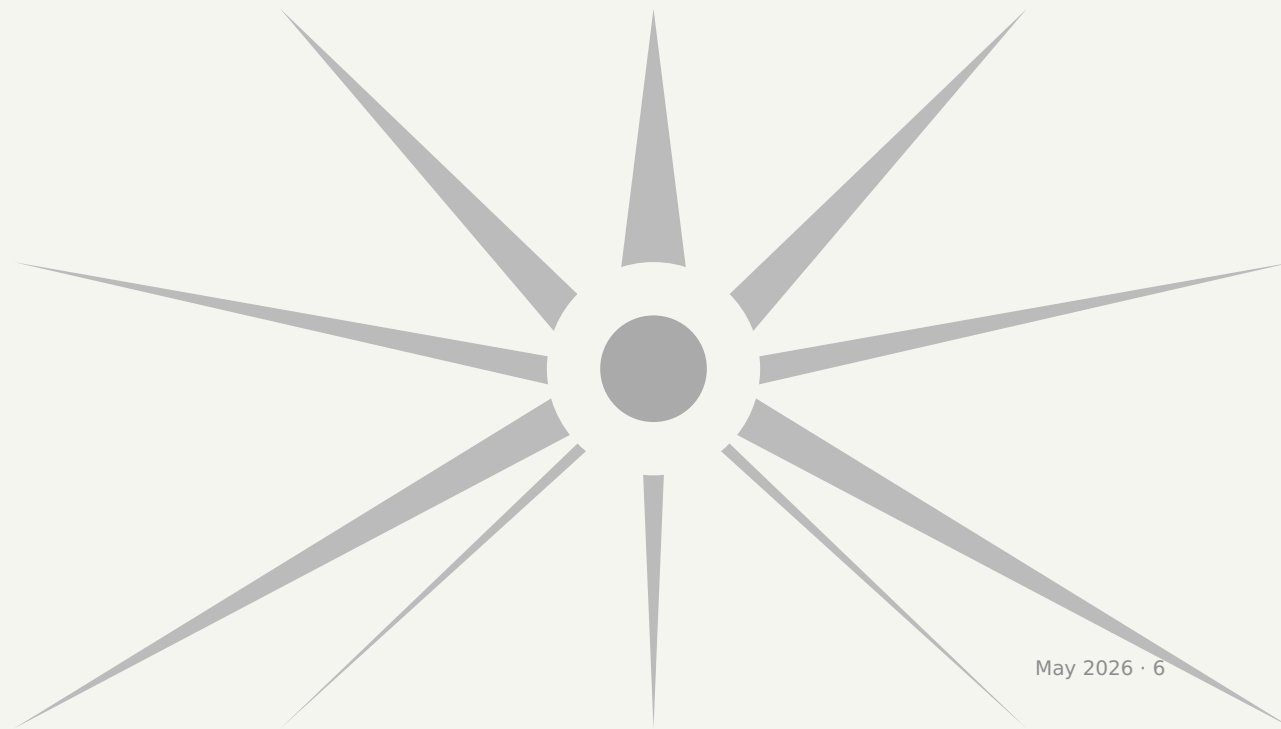
Early: go deep.
Later: go wide.

Depth builds expertise and credibility.
Breadth builds leadership and vision.



Early on, never say "it's not my job."

Later on — let people do their job.
Ownership first. Delegation comes with seniority.



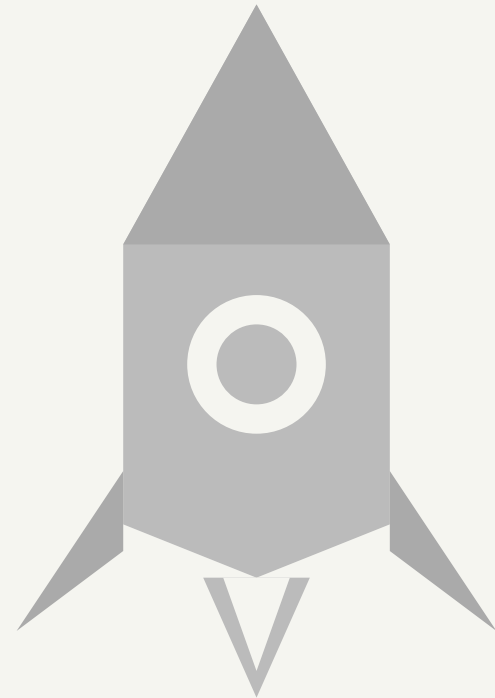
Growth & Performance

How to actually get better — and faster.

You grow by making your boss' life **easier**.

Your job is to solve your manager's problems — not just your tasks.

That's what promotions are made of.



Action >>> Thought.

No one gets rewarded for "I had the same idea."
Execution separates dreamers from doers.



No job is 9-to-5.

Your job is the amount of focused time you spend on it.
Clock-watching is a career limiter.



SHORT TERM

Hustle → grow fast.

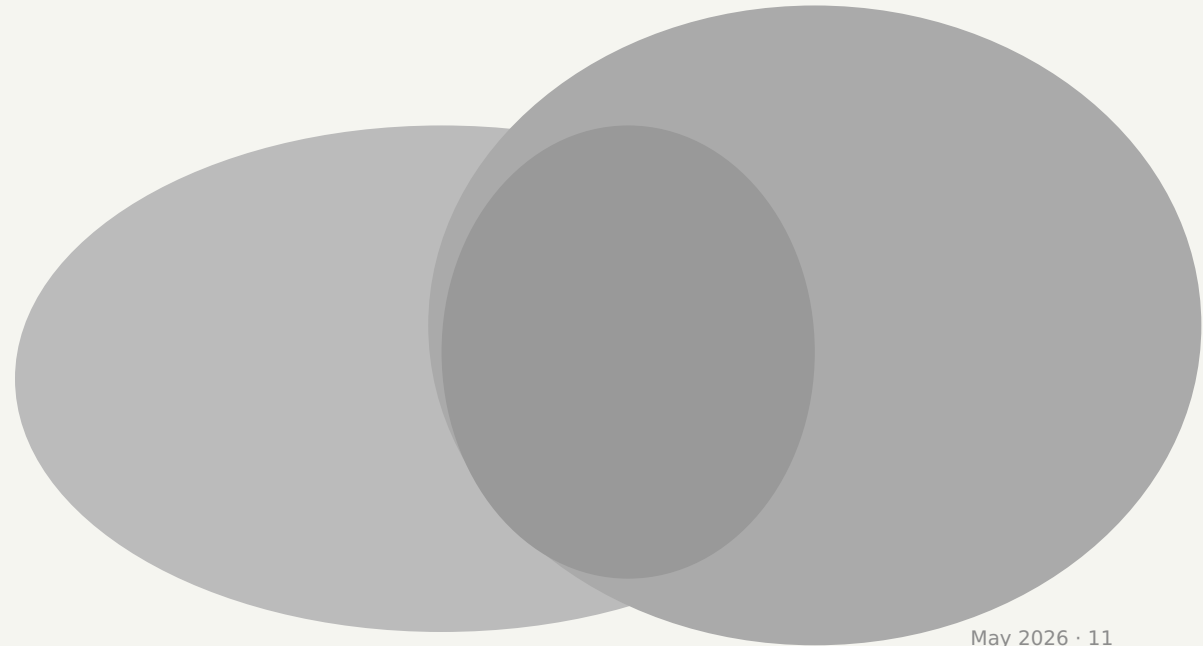
Sprint culture gets early wins and early burnout.

LONG TERM

Pace yourself →

grow **big**.

Consistency compounds. Careers are marathons.



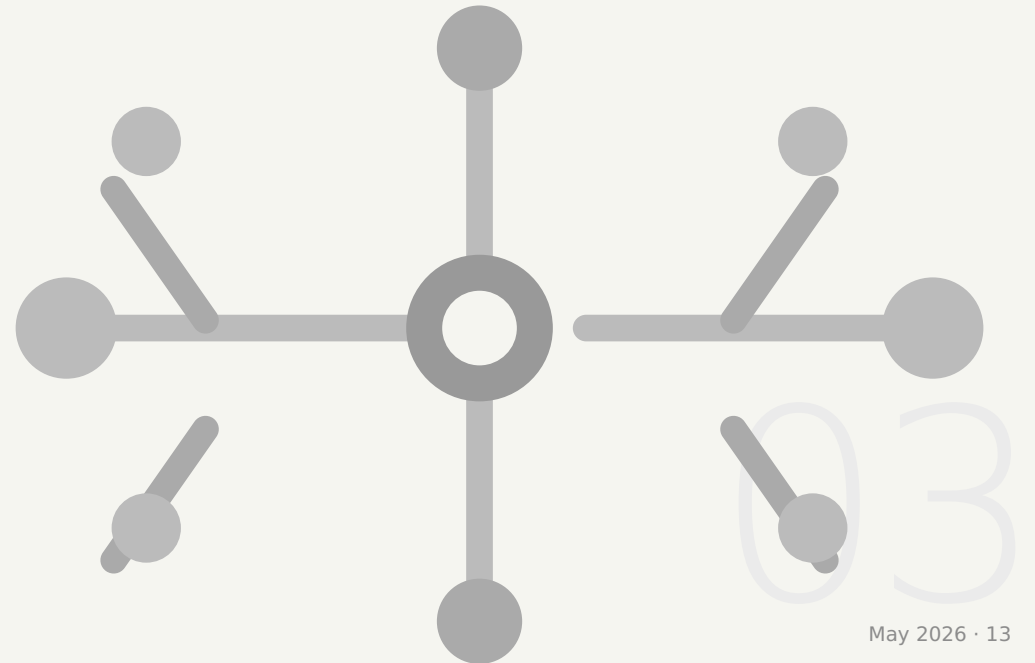
Solve problems.

Those who solve problems are rewarded more than those who maintain the status quo.



| People & Leadership

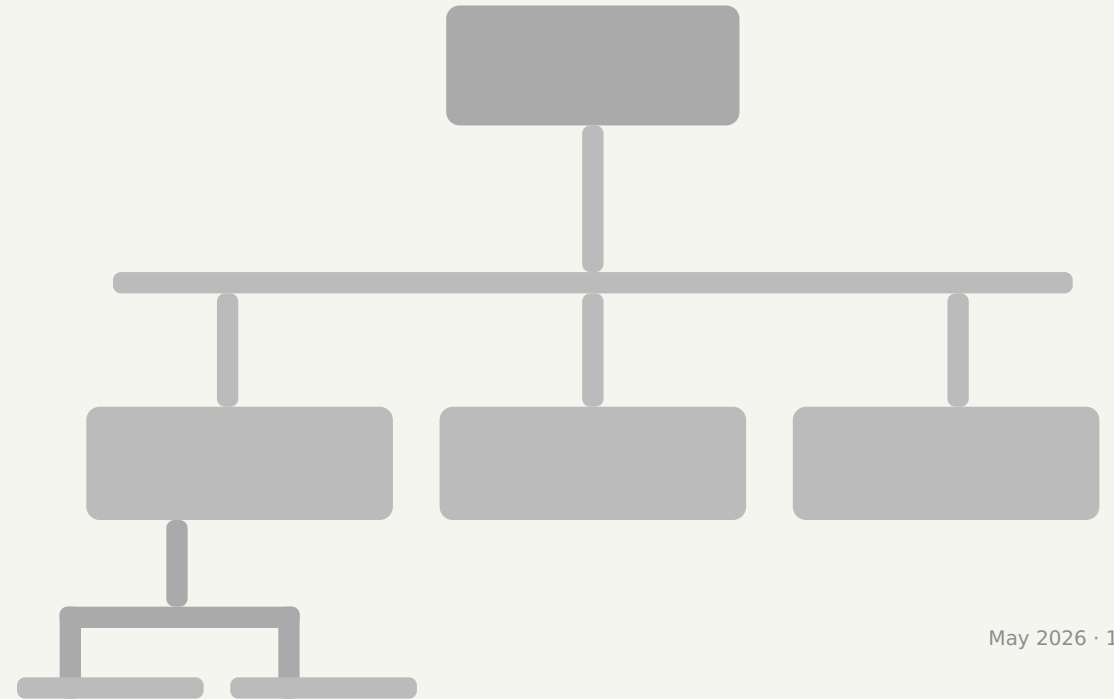
Every career is ultimately about managing humans.



Eventually, every role ends
up
about managing people.

Every. Role.

Being great at the work $\neq$ being great at managing it.



"Managing oneself is very different from managing others."

Star performers become bad managers when they apply individual-contributor habits to team leadership.



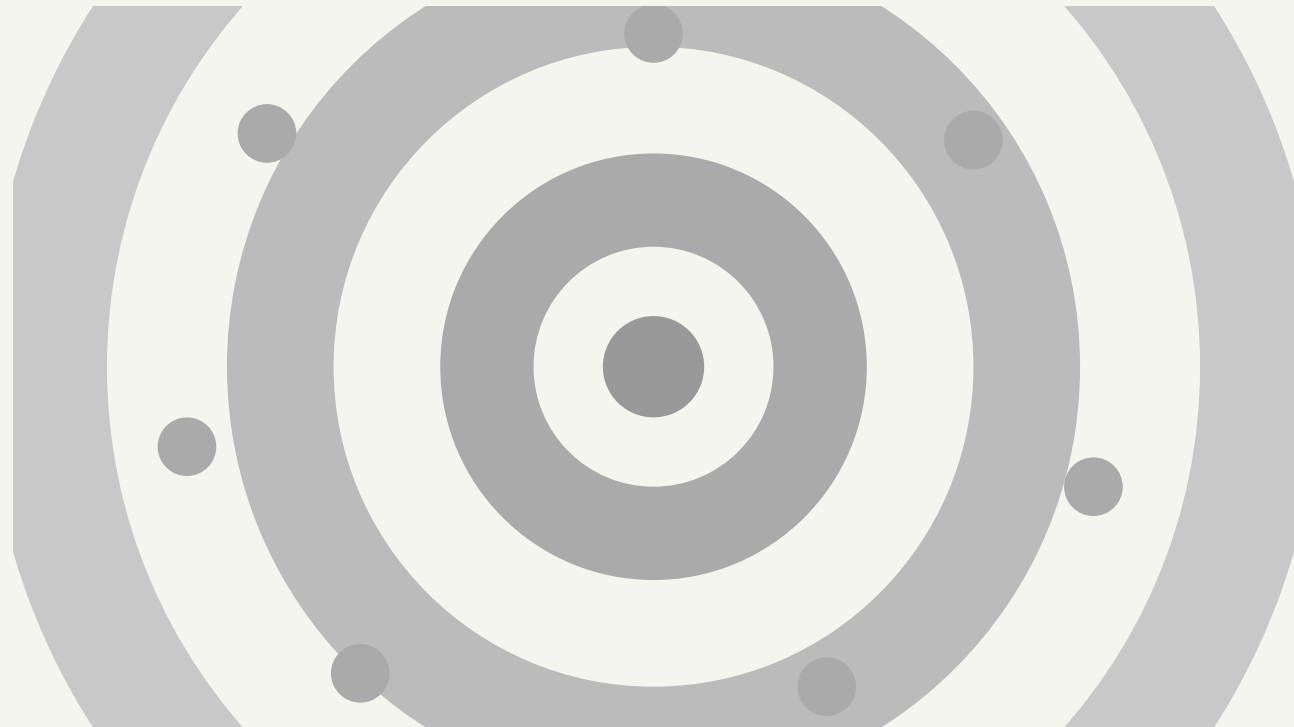
Your boss matters.

A strict, competent manager who gives harsh feedback will teach you far more than a kind, incompetent one.



Your network is your opportunity generator.

How you treated your colleagues determines the quality and quantity of opportunities that come through them.



Be nice. Help people.

The bigger the audience who likes you,
the more seriously you will be taken.



Mindset & Reality

The things about work culture nobody puts in the job description.



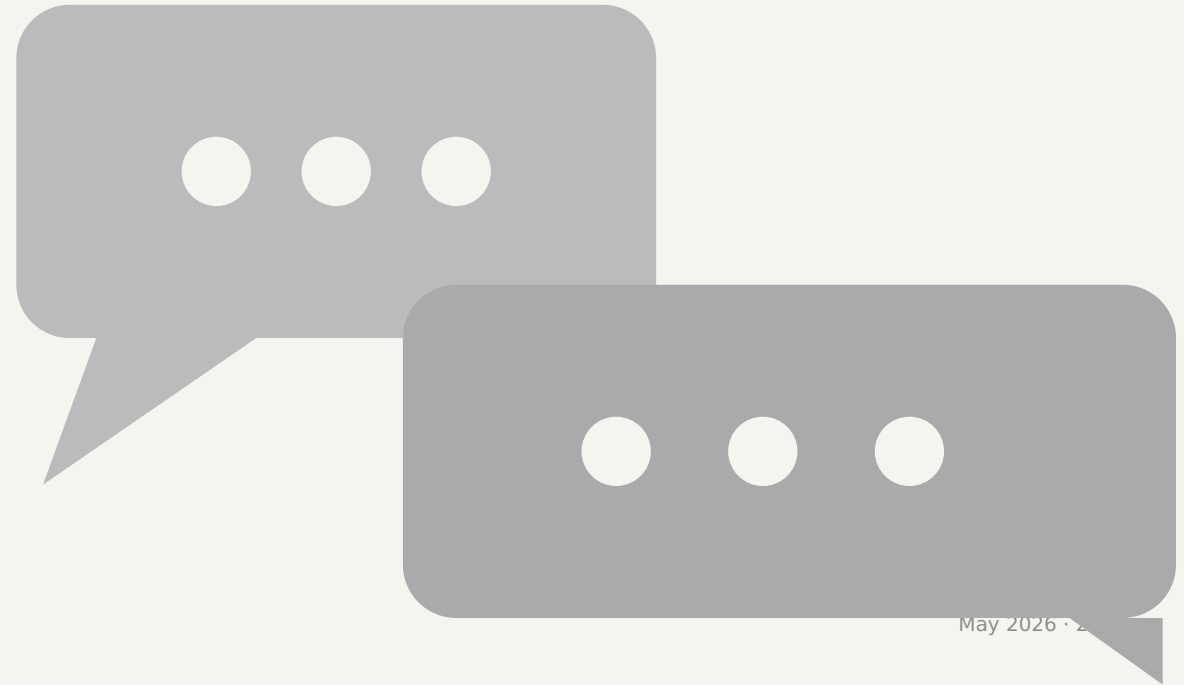
Keeping your word
is **immensely** rewarded.

Once you make a commitment, no one should
need to follow up on you. Ever.



Feedback is not given. Feedback is sought.

Those who actively seek it are the ones
who can handle the truth — and grow from it.



When all leaders play politics, it's no longer politics.

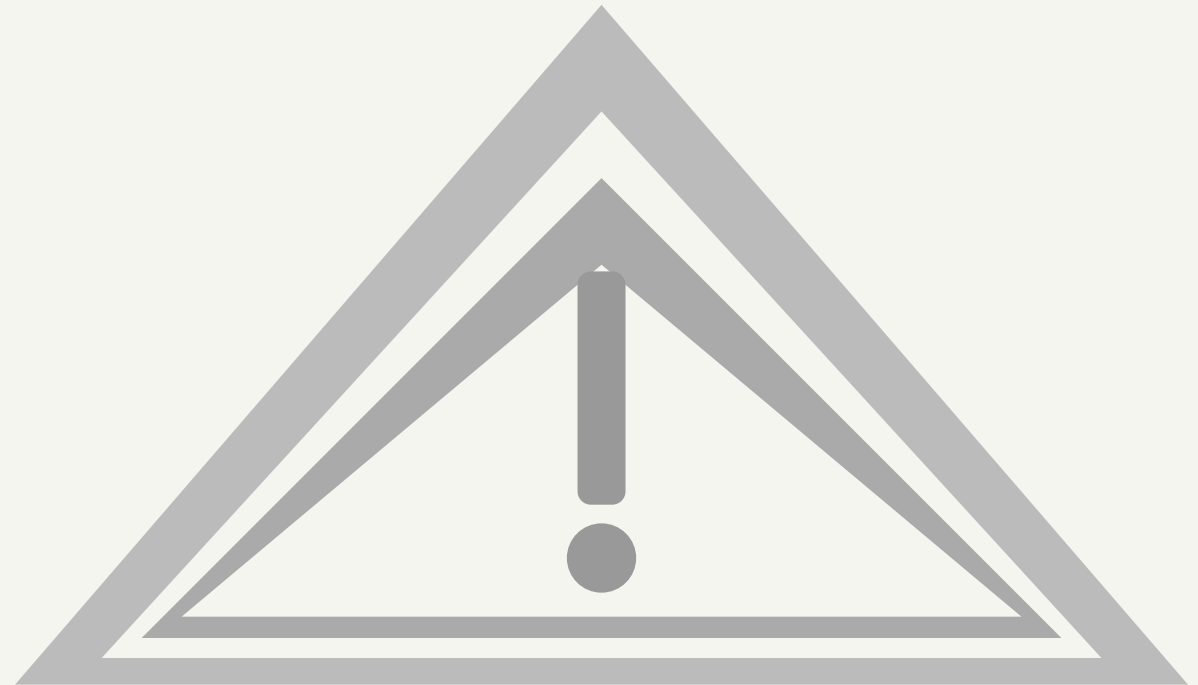
It's **the culture**.

Choose your workplace culture carefully — it will shape you.



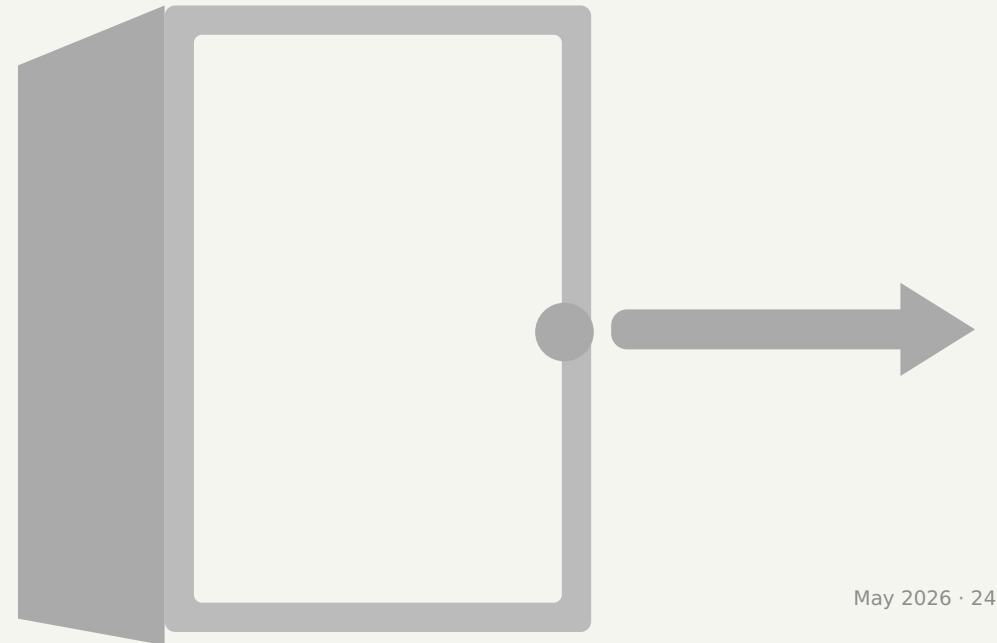
Corporate perks are a trap for the **entitled**.

Those who feel entitled to privileges rarely win.
Earn everything. Assume nothing.



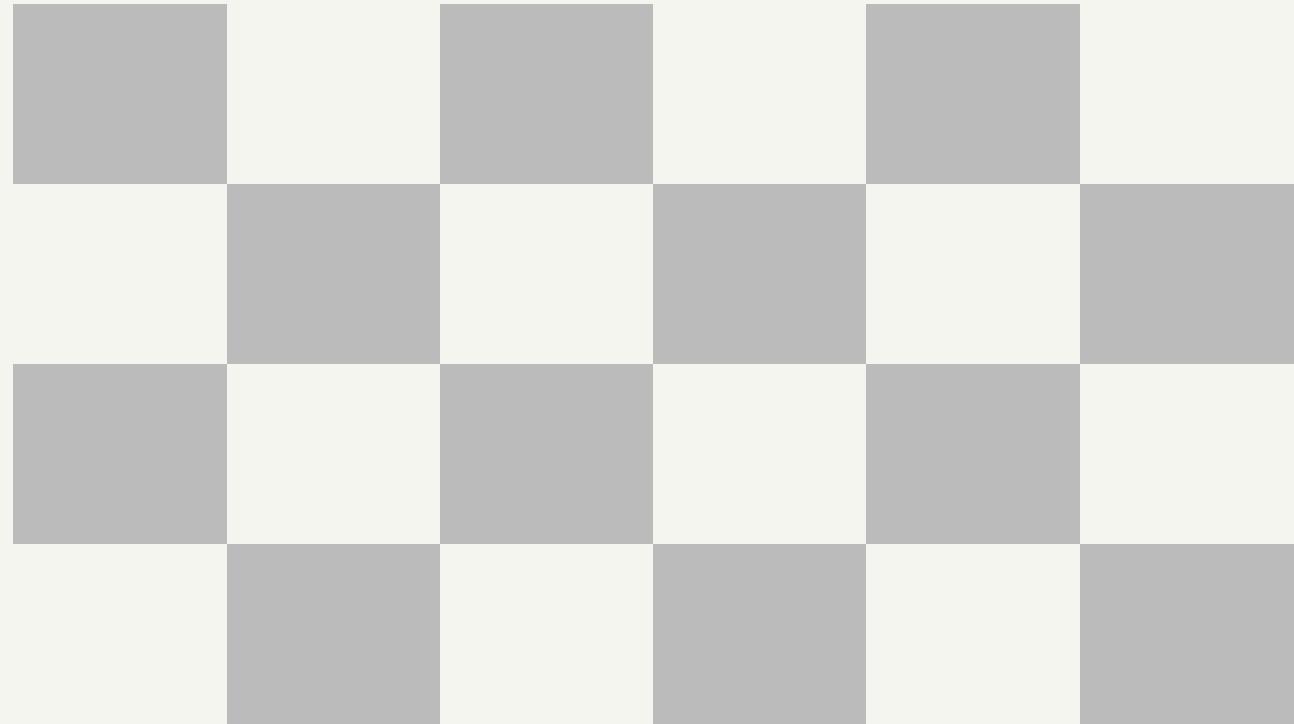
Toxic jobs **do exist.**

No respect. No recognition. No progress.
Recognize them — and plan your exit.



Career Strategy

Playing the long game.



Likeability wins interview tie-breakers.

Almost all close calls go to the more likeable candidate.
Smile. Be human. Show warmth.



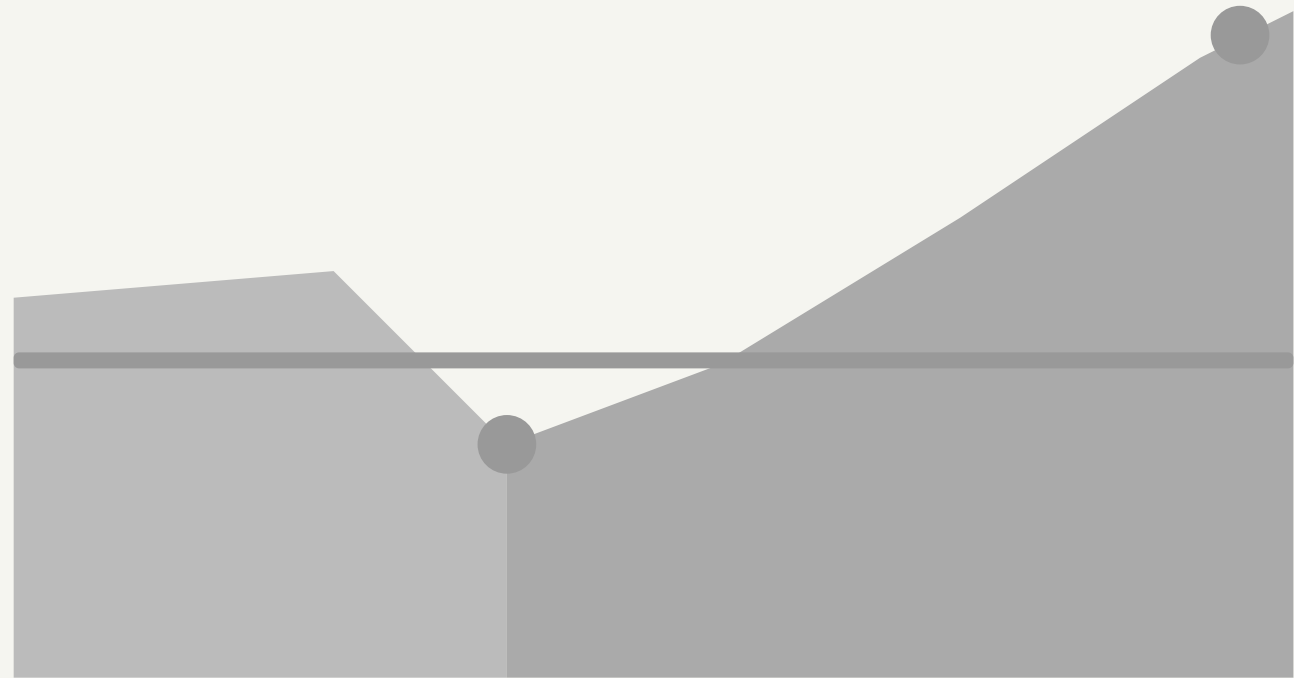
If you hate it,
you'll never be the best at it.

Unhappiness is a performance ceiling.
Passion is a performance multiplier.



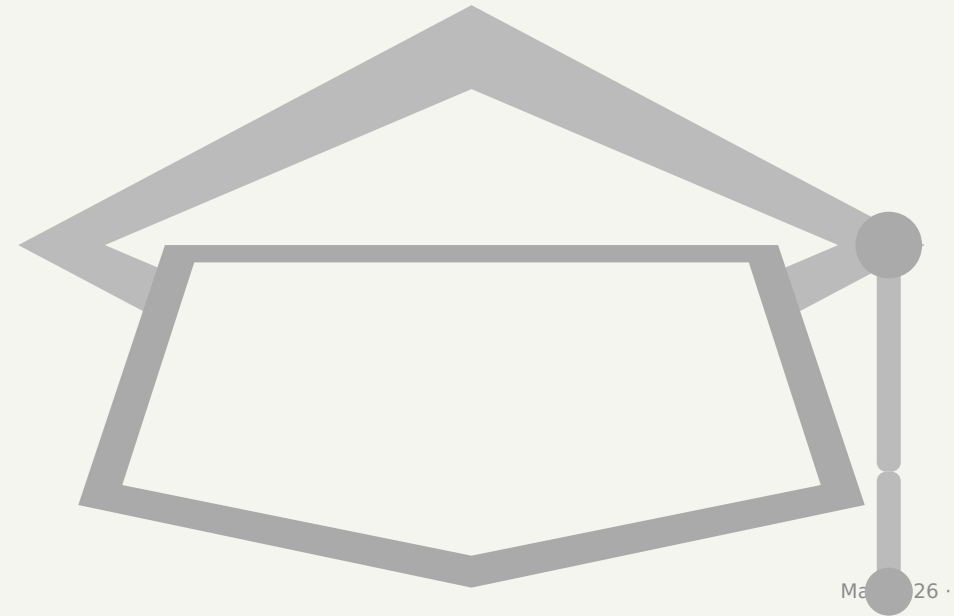
Take a pay cut for the right experience.

The gap will be covered faster than you think.
Experience compounds. Salary follows.



College does not train you for **work**.

College teaches you, then tests you.
Work tests you, then teaches you.



You don't *find* passion.
You *grow* it.

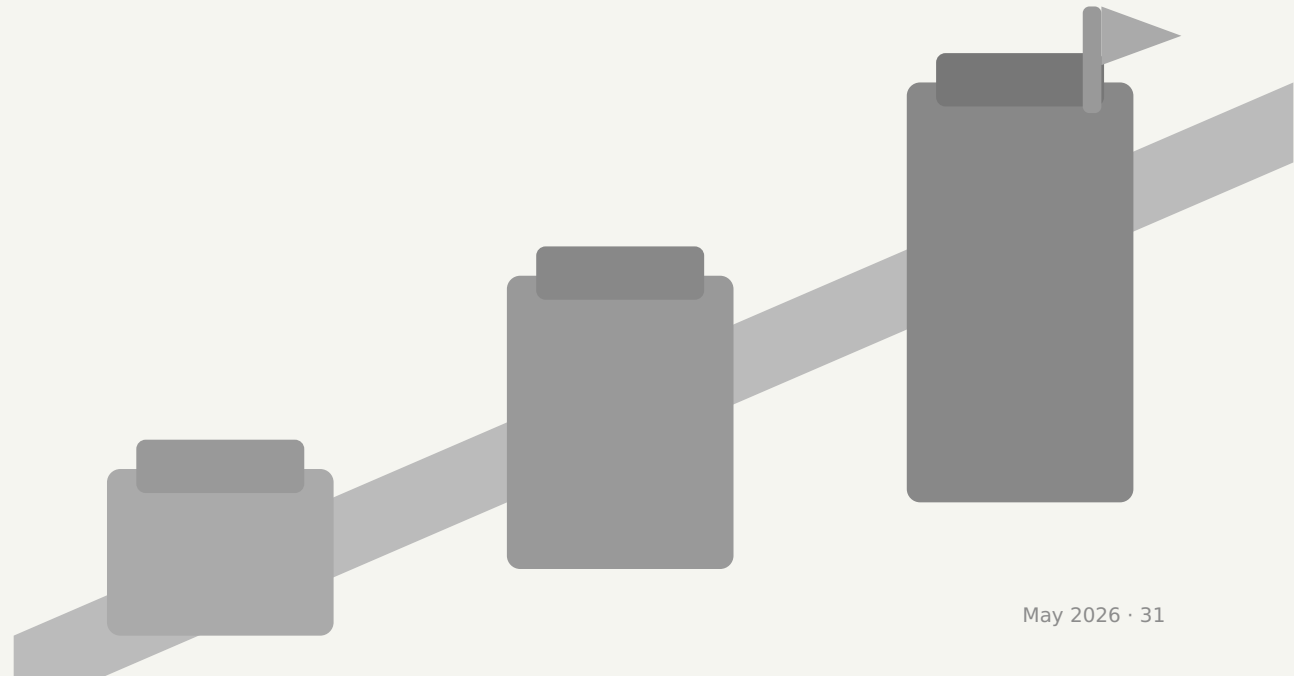
Passion is not waiting to be discovered — it's built
through exploration.

Go try things. The path reveals itself.



Use your 20s to explore.
Your 30s to build.
Your 40s to retire financially.

A career in three chapters.



We learn it on our own. Now you don't have to.

All 25 lessons — hard-won and freely shared.